MOUNTAINEER SUMMER 1999



Neighbor to Neighbor

by Kathy Neill

I teach research methods to graduate students in nursing at Georgetown University and conduct research on women's health issues. Presently, I am interviewing women with breast cancer who are deciding about treatment and reconstruction. I am also looking at issues of informed consent. I am searching for ways that we in the health professions can be more supportive during this very stressful time. How can I "package" what we experience on the mountainside and share it with these women and their families as they face a serious illness and make difficult decisions?

I think, we, who live on the mountain, believe that our environment influences us and that is one of the important reasons we are here. The peace of the mountains relaxes and soothes us. We are refreshed by the deep green forest, rested by the quiet songs of birds, intrigued by the graceful shyness of deer, enriched by the sparkling stars, healed by the views of the mountains, and energized by the walks with nature.

One of my favorite authors is Willa Cather. I often think of her when I reflect on life here on the mountainside. Willa Cather's life and mine seem to have worked in reverse patterns. I was born in Nebraska and moved to Virginia as a young adult. She was born in Virginia and moved to Nebraska while still a child. We both, however, share a love of family and nature and recognize their energizing and healing effects on the human psyche. As an adult, Willa wrote stirring stories of Midwestern settlers with strong family values who worked very hard to build homes and a livelihood on the Great Plain.

She wrote with enthusiasm about Nebraska. Eastern Nebraska, where I was born, is a gently rolling plain of either grass, or corn or soybeans. There are very few trees--just a few cottonwoods along a stream where one can cool off from the sun. One feels very small in relation to the dominant sky, the distant horizon, the ever present wind, and the "ocean" of plains. There are no mountains to define or confine your views. There are no forests to enrich your nature walks. Instead, the environment heals you with space, skies, sun, wind and clouds during the day and numerous stars at night.

During my life there, the plain beauty of Nebraska worked its magic on me as it did on Willa Cather. Yet, on the mountainside, where Ed and I have built our retreat from our busy work lives in Washington, the experience of nature is equally innervating. The environment restores nature to my soul and body and brings childhood memories of the variety of nature gifts that God had given us.



Front: Bridget Borchers, Wendy Smith, Helen Pearson, Gwyn Sirota, Rear: Blake Lorenz, Janice Lorenz, Robert Borchers, Glen Pearson, Bradley Pearson, Sherry Rubin

COMMUNICATIONS SOCIAL

Rosemary Bigelow

Our committee is in high gear for the busy summer "social season" on the Mountainside. On Sunday, June 13th we held our second Newcomers' Brunch; providing the opportunity to meet and welcome our newest CMA neighbors. The brunch was held at the barn and was attended by about 40 people, including the following new members: Robert and Bridget Borchers, Glen and Helen Pearson and their son, and Sherry Rubin. Many thanks to the members of the Committee who provided all the food and handwritten calligraphy name tags. A special thanks to Nancy Thompson who planned the whole event.

Elmer Broxson has again agreed to head the committee to plan a catered dinner at the barn following our annual CMA meeting on July 17, 1999. Last year we had about 65 members participate and it was a lot of fun. We will begin with a cocktail hour with wine and hors d'oeuvres provided by the committee, followed by a catered dinner. The cost per member will be $15 for adults and $8 for children under 12. Please RSVP and send your check to Elmer Broxson, made out to CMA, no later than July 13, 1999. We need to give the caterer a final number by then. Also look for details in the packet which goes out for the annual meeting. Do plan to come, it's a great way to meet and socialize with your CMA neighbors.

Last year we revived an old CMA tradition that some CMA members hold open houses during the weekend of the annual meeting. This year we will have 3 open houses: David and Karen Bakkegard (P-8), Glen and Helen Pearson and Sherry Rubin, (S-5), and Wendy Smith (C-5). Open houses will be held at 11AM, Sunday, July 18th. Please let your calling tree contact person know if you are planning to attend the open houses so we can give these members an idea of how many people to expect.

Welcome back to Jim and Harriet Lancaster, who have just returned from five years in Africa, where Harriet was head of the Peace Corps for Gana. They plan to be in residence at Coolfont for most of the summer.

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(Communications continued)

Thank you to Greta Weinberger, who is "retiring" as a Telephone Tree calling volunteer.

Did you know:

The US Naval Academy has donated a deep space telescope to Berkeley Springs. There is a local group actively involved in raising funds and planning the construction of a conservatory to house the telescope. Hopes are that the basic conservatory can be built this summer. There is a foundation to receive contributions and there will be skywatch parties held throughout the summer. Watch the local newspapers for more information.

The Concerts in the Park series will be held at 5:30PM every Saturday from July 10 to August 18. Don't forget the annual Studio Tour from 10AM to 6PM, August 14 and 15. You can access a full calendar of events for Berkeley Springs on the web at www.berkeleysprings.com.

We have a new neighbor on Cold Run Valley Road, Suzen Segall. She is a Certified Wellness Personal Trainer and massage therapist. She specializes in combining ancient acupressure techniques, traditional Swedish massage and foot reflexology. Suzen also teaches Tai Chi. If you are interested in an introductory session to Tai Chi, or a massage, or information on a wellness weekend call Suzen at 258-9082 or check out her website at www.wellnesstraining.com

High Lawn Inn will be offering its Silver Service Dinners on 7/4 and 7/31, 8/21, 9/4 and every Saturday evening in October. Call well ahead for reservations, 258-5700.

Nominating Committee

Richard Lehman

The Committee this year was fortunate to have found an exceptionally strong slate of five candidates who are willing to run for the CMA Board: Marie Barrett, Joan Bradfield, Elmer Broxson, Lon Dring and Paul Kagen. I would like to thank the Committee members: Sandy Bain, Ed Neill, Frank Rutherford and Nancy Thompson for the many hours of work they put in.

With a volunteer Board such as we have, the Nominating Committee this year had difficulty finding more than the requisite number to run. In recent years, we have been able to fine the requisite number, but in each year, willing, capable and experienced members have been prevented from running because of the Bylaw that bars their eligibility to run by virtue of being a spouse of a Committee member. It is unclear to me how this Bylaw is in any way beneficial to CMA. No less an authority than Robert's Rules of Order, provides arguments why such rules are discriminatory and thus harmful to an organization. This Bylaw arbitrarily screens out as many as five potential candidates for the Board each year. The Nominating Committee therefore makes the following recommendations:

1. The 1997-9 procedures be used as the basis for the conduct of future CMA elections.

2. The Board should instruct next year's Nominating Committee to review the need for the Bylaw that bars spouses of Committee members from being nominated as a candidate for the Board, and to make recommendations to the Board regarding possible changes in this Bylaw.

3. The new Nominating Committee should be instructed to review the need for use of proxy ballots in the election of Board Members, and to make recommendations to the Board regarding possible changes in CMA Bylaws that relate to such proxies. If the ballot packages are mailed to CMA members more than four weeks in advance of the Annual Meeting, this would seem to allow more than enough time, even for those CMA members who reside abroad, to return their ballots by mail in time to be received and counted without the need for proxies.

Recreation Committee

Elaine Anderson

The Recreation Committee has been working on several projects this year, which include:

In March the Committee began to talk with interested builders about the pool changing rooms and toilets. The Committee has found the job challenging, in that it is a small job, and many builders are very busy with larger obligations. The goal is to have the project completed in 1999.

Pool passes were mailed out in time for the opening of the pool over Memorial Day weekend. Thanks to Alice for your help. Two lifeguards, Stephanie and Rebecca, have been hired by John Hobday. It was a beautiful weekend and the pool was a busy place. We are in the process of buying three more lounge chairs and three more chairs for the pool area. Three umbrellas will also be bought to replace the mouse damaged old umbrellas.

The tennis courts are open and the steps are being repaired by John Hobday. The courts are useable but in need of some work. The Committee and the Board are looking into ways to do what is needed.

The barn use policy and request procedures have been put on a form and is available through John Hobday. If you want to use the barn or the pool after hours you must fill out a request.

If you plan to enjoy the recreational opportunities on the mountainside, have a safe and wonderful time.

DACC Committee

Richard Kaufman

The covenants to the properties on the mountainside states that all buildings, fences or other structures, or changes and additions to these structures, must be approved by an architectural committee, as to harmony of external design and location in relation to surrounding structures and topography. Thus, the Bylaws of CMA require this committee to review all plans for improvements and determine that they are consistent with the covenants, the building guidelines and the Regulations and Guidelines Regarding the Use of Property. The committee is also required to review the building guidelines annually. Over the past year, the members of the committee have followed our mandate, as set out in the Covenants and Bylaws to assure that the mountainside continues to develop in ways that preserve the values of the community.

We are pleased to report that we have received excellent cooperation from all those who have undertaken new construction or improvement projects. One new home is presently under construction at R-8. Several home improvement projects are under way, or soon will be.

The committee also has been considering the proposed construction of an office within the barn. Funds were set aside for this project in the budget and, accordingly, the committee asked an engineer to look into its feasibility. For several reasons, it was determined to be not feasible or practical to place an office in the part of the barn that was considered Other options are presently being explored.

A proposed revision of the Regulations and Guidelines Regarding the Use of Property, has been approved by the Board and will be discussed at the annual meeting.

DIRECTORY CHANGES

Please make the following changes in your telephone directory:

L-5: Sold from Amoroso to Sonny & Kathryn Izon, 4320 Hamilton St. #203, Hyattsville, MD 20781, phone: 301-699-3062

B-3: Sugrue new address: 2801 Park Center Drive #1805, Alexandria, VA, 22302, phone: 703-566-0434

K-16: Dowling new address: 10 Hartley Place, Gaithersburg, MD 20878, 301-948-1456

K-17: Lehman's phone: 301-229-3264

The Water Systems Committee was created last year to oversee the operation of the CMA water and sewer systems in conformity with the regulations of the Public Service Commission (water rates), the Bureau of Public Health (water supply) and the Environmental Protection Division (sewage). The CMA is assisted in dealing with these state agencies through membership in the West Virginia Rural Water Association, the WV branch of a national organization of small water systems founded in the 1970s.

At present, the Committee is assisting the Board in applying to the PSC for a reduction in our water rates and in preparing for a possible power outage on January 1, 2000 ("the Y2K bug"). We are also working with our engineer, J. Lewis, in submitting to the BPH for approval our plans for the completion of the CMA Water Upgrade. And, finally, John Hobday has inspected the septic tanks at each CMA house and reported to the Board that none of them need pumping at present.

Should you have questions about any of these activities, please call either John Hobday at 304-258-8141 or Elmer Broxson at 202-333-8872. **Reminder: to save water and money, please turn off your water at the valve where the line enters the house when the house is not occupied.**

President's Report

Frank Rutherford

It is hard to believe that it has been a year since the last annual meeting. When I first drew up my list of ten goals for the year, it seemed that it would be a simple task to complete them before the next annual meeting. Even though the Board has been working very hard on all of these issues, we have not completed all of them. A short status report follows:

1. DACC: Under the direction of Richard Kaufman they have been dealing with the routine issues relating to its charge.
2. Security: We now have security provided by CRI on a regular basis thanks to Jackson Bain's diligent work.
3. Barn office and pool house: We wanted to have these two projects completed by the annual meeting but for a variety of reasons they are still in the planning stages.
4. Snow removal: This year we had a contract with CRI and from the reports I received, all went well.
5. Water systems: The major upgrade was completed last year and this year we have focused on minor upgrades. Since July 1, 1998, we have split our bookkeeping in order to determine our true cost of supplying water to the mountainside. By the end of the summer, we hope to have all the necessary paper work done for the filing with the PSC.
6. The Board has endorsed the changes in the Covenants which will be discussed at the annual meeting. The association must approve the changes in a separated ballot vote.
7. The Ad Hoc Committee has been monitoring the expansion of Coolfont Resort. The major expansion plans that Sam discussed at the annual meeting have been scaled back.
8. Work on the T-section was slowed this winter. At the moment, there is no time table for its completion.

This year has been one filled with great losses. This winter we lost Lee Weinberger, a Board member and former President of CMA, who had guided the association through the difficult times of the water system upgrade. Lee spent countless hours on the mountainside making it a better place for all of us.

At the May meeting of the Board, Roland Siushansian, our treasurer, submitted his resignation as a Board member effective at the annual meeting. Roland has served the Board for the past three years and his relentless pursuit of keeping our costs down will be missed. His wife, Mary Ann, has helped him with the job along with her tasks of doing the directory and the newsletter. She will continue to do the newsletter. I want to thank both of them for the countless hours spent working on the associations business. Much of their time "relaxing" at their home on the mountainside over the past few years has been spent working for CMA.

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I feel that the operations on the mountainside have gone smoothly because of our wonderful Operations Manager, John Hobday. Most of us never see John, but the quality of his work is visible every time we visit the mountainside.

In closing, I want to thank all the volunteers, committee chairs, and board members for helping me to make it through the year. A special thanks to our out going board members, Charlie Balkan, Jackson Bain, Roland Siushansian and Joan Bradfield (who is running for reelection). CMA is a volunteer organization that counts on its members for help. Please consider helping us by serving on a committee or by hosting a board meeting or pot luck dinner.

HOUSES AND LOTS FOR SALE

A-2 Lot: $25,000
H-1 Lot: $41,500
K-1 Lot: $42,500
K-2 Lot: $48,000
both for $78,000

K-12 Lot: $36,900
K-14 Lot: $45,000
Q-7 Lot: $47,000
S-6 Lot: $68,950

D-1 House: $265,000
K-5 House: $235,000
K--6 House: $159,500
P-5 House: $129,900
Q-9 House: $184,900

LET'S MEET SOME NEW PEOPLE

We love our second home at Coolfont! Sandy visited the area a couple of times and found the beauty and tranquility most appealing. She decided to find a getaway in the Berkeley Springs area and impetuously bought a lot at Coolfont and began building a house. As fate would have it, she and Tom met in the early stages of construction and had a wonderful time finishing the house together. Hence, the name of our house is Kismet! Happy pursuits of retirees include doing a lot of travelling...trips abroad or visits to grandchildren. We look forward to meeting our new neighbors at Coolfont. The pot luck dinners sound great! Hopefully, we can attend one soon!

Sandra Dalsheimer and Tom Hess, S-2 Kismet

R-8 is our RV
Bridget and Bob Borchers

Late in 1993 a position with the National Science Foundation brought Bob and Bridget Borchers East after many years in Livermore, California and Madison, Wisconsin. Through the years, we have enjoyed camping with our three children, and then as just a couple. Our expectation was to one day purchase a small travel trailer and camp in comfort, as we had seen so many others do, especially in the West. During our first winter in the East, long time friends, Bob and Sally Dowling, invited us to spend a week-end at their new retreat at Coolfont, On Eagle's Wings. In spite of the deep snow and ice, it was lovely.

A few years passed and the idea of an RV grew dimmer; especially in view of the traffic in the Washington, D.C./Northern Virginia metro area. On something of a whim, we decided to drive up to Coolfont on a pleasant August day in 1998. Charles Stuart showed us around and it was love at first sight with the mountainside and R-8. So, R-8 is now our RV.

Dee and Jim Lobley
K-15

Dee and I bought a cabinet manufacturing company back in 1989. The company, Hagerstown Kitchens, is located in Hagerstown, MD, which dictated a move from Reston, VA. to Hagerstown. With our three boys we made the trek over the mountain and into the world of relaxed hustle. Our oldest son, David, graduated from Salisbury State last year and is currently working in North Carolina. Andrew, our second son, graduated in June from Mount Saint Mary's. He will be attending law school in the fall. Our youngest, Jimmie, will be a sophomore at The Mount

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I first visited Coolfont three years ago for a conference. I was so impressed that I invited all of my Reps to join me for a four day conference. We simply had a blast. Dee and I continued to use the resort for a year until I finally said let's buy a place. We have only been up to visit once since then. Our boys have each visited for a week but Dee and I for only one night. Shameful! I will use the old work excuse. The economy is good and that is the time for me to push. We sell from Maine to Florida and as far west as Colorado, so it does keep me busy.

Prior to Hagerstown Kitchens, I was a lobbyist in Washington, and prior to that, the financial advisor to The Washington Post subsidiaries. Dee has her degree in biology. However she has also been the sole reason for my degrees, as well as David, Andrew and hopefully, soon, Jimmie's degrees.

Nancy and Murray Miskin
N-4 Camp David

My husband, Murray, our son Daniel (age 10), and I would like to introduce ourselves and let you know how we came to buy a home in the Coolfont Mountainside Association Community. I am originally from Alexandria, Virginia, and moved to Toronto, Ontario in 1979, where I took a position as a Consultant with the Addiction Research Foundation If you may remember, jobs were scarce in the US in 1979, so I headed North after finishing a Master of Science Degree from the University of Arizona. (Many people have wondered why I would go from Arizona to Canada; I am a woman of extremes.) I met Murray in 1979, who was just finishing law school in Toronto. We got married in 1982, and had a son, Daniel, in 1989 (life certainly changed).

A few times a year, my family and I would visit my brother and sister who live in Stafford VA, and Bethesda, MD respectively. One Labour Day weekend in 1994, my sister suggested we meet in a secret "get a way place" where she goes with her husband to escape from work, children, who still live at home, and grandchildren. This special place was Berkeley Springs. We stayed at the Country Inn and had dinner one night at the Tree Top Restaurant. We fell in love with Coolfont and agreed to return a year later and stay in a chalet. Again, we had a fabulous time and in the summer of 1998 returned. We met Charles Stewart who introduced us to Camp David, which was for sale. We decided to buy, closed in October, and now are thrilled we can visit four times a year on the guaranteed rental program.

Now that we have our home in WV, for some reason, my family wants to come and see us more than ever (curious). Seriously though, it is great that our son has more contact with his uncle, aunt and cousins in the US. He has dual citizenship and can choose to live in either country in his adult life. We have, unfortunately, not yet been able to meet many people in the association due to the distance and the timing of our trips. We hope on our next visit to Camp David in June/July, we may be able to get in touch with more of our neighbors and other association members.

Tanya George and Norman Rosenburg
K-9 Black Forest

I first came to Coolfont in the late seventies when I worked for the Peace Corps. Coolfont was a popular site for staff retreats and orientations for volunteers before the boarded planes to another part of the world. I always vied for a room in one of the houses rather than the lodge, even though it meant finding my way up the road after a late meeting. It seemed a fair price for waking up in the trees before spending hours n a room full of people and flip charts. Twenty years later, my husband and I bought one of those houses and I have mixed feelings about sharing it. We are on Coolfont's rental program and hope those who rent our house take the care I did. We bought Black Forest (K-9) this past spring after several visits to Coolfont with our sons Max and Alexander, who are five. After years away, friends convinced us Coolfont was the perfect family destination. We decided it was also the perfect hideout from the stress of our Washington jobs. My husband is the Executive Director of the New Israel Fund, a group promoting democracy and civil rights in Israel. I was working for Partners of the Americas, a volunteer-based organization that carries out technical assistance and training projects in Latin America and the Caribbean. We both needed to get out of town more often and our sons needed woods to play in.

I have been amazed at how little Coolfont has changed over the years. It's timelessness, its beauty and the feeling of being somewhere althogether different have made it an important part of our life as a family. We have been spending a weekend a month at Black Forest and plan to be there more this summer. We all love hiking through the woods, swimming in the outdoor pool and exploring Berkeley Springs. We are a noisy lot, so if you see or hear us coming through the woods, please introduce yourselves. Norman, Max, Alexander and I look forward to meeting you.

After three years of doing the Mountaineer newsletter I had decided I needed a break and told "the powers that be" that this would be my last one. However, after much soul searching and remembering that CMA is a volunteer organization I decided to stay on as editor of the Mountaineer. I would like to take this opportunity to thank everyone who, when I asked for an article, usually complied. For those of you who didn't supply me with an article, maybe next time I ask, you'll have something for me. I'd like to take this opportunity to thank Lorraine Kujawa who was going to take over the newsletter from me. Maybe next year.

Mary Ann Siushansian